

HYPER HISTORY

“THE PASSENGER PIGEON”

Two-Column A/V Script

Client Google Arts & Culture
Partner credits The Henry Ford, Library of Virginia
Produced with Vsauce2
Host Kevin (Vsauce2)
TRT 2:55
Aspect 16:9, 1920x1080

VIDEO	AUDIO
Host to camera	KEVIN (SYNC): Hello again, it’s me, Kevin, from the YouTube science channel, Vsauce2.
Host to camera	KEVIN (SYNC): What if I told you that in the 1800s, a single species of bird was believed to account for up to 40 percent of all winged creatures in North America?
Contemporary: birdwatching	KEVIN (VO): What if I told you you’ve never seen this bird before in your entire life? And you never will.
Archival: speaker addressing camera	KEVIN (VO): The story of the passenger pigeon is a tragic tale. An age-old reminder that just because you can, doesn’t mean you should.
Natural history plate against archival bird handling	KEVIN (VO): First things first: passenger pigeons are not CARRIER PIGEONS.

VIDEO	AUDIO
Archival: early aviation	KEVIN (VO): They never delivered parcels, postcards, or dropped off acceptance letters to magic school.
Archival fantasy film with caption gag	GAG VO: "You're a wizard, Henry..."
Natural history plates animated on a colour field	KEVIN (VO): Passenger pigeons were beautiful. Elegant. More like doves than the common pigeon.
Etymology graphic	KEVIN (VO): Their name is actually derived from the French word passager, which means "passing by."
Archival melodrama, close-up, with caption gag	GAG VO: "Bon voyage, little pigeon... we won't forget you..."
Animated map: migration range and population scale	KEVIN (VO): In the early 1800s, their population peaked around 5 BILLION in North America. They migrated in flocks that were a mile wide and 300 miles long.
Motion graphic: scale comparison	KEVIN (VO): If you lined all of them up from beak to tail, they would wrap around the earth twenty-two times!
Silent-era fantasy animation	KEVIN (VO): Which, as it turns out, only gets you a quarter of the way around Jupiter.
Planetary imagery: Jupiter	KEVIN (VO): Jupiter's BIG!
Museum specimen collection	KEVIN (VO): But these large flocks proved to be a big problem for the passenger pigeon. It was this survival instinct that, ironically and sadly, led to their downfall.
Type treatment over food imagery	KEVIN (VO): The Native American people of the Seneca tribe called the bird jahgowa, or "Big Bread." For them it was like a double-double, small fries and a large shake, with wings.

VIDEO	AUDIO
Archival: hunting	KEVIN (VO): Hunters said it was easier than shooting fish in a barrel. A single shotgun blast could take out as many as 5 DOZEN birds.
Retro game pastiche with score counter	KEVIN (VO): Mass hunts were known to bring down 50,000 pigeons A DAY. And quickly the population fell from 5 billion... to 1...
Archival: flock in flight	KEVIN (VO): By the time we got to 1910, there was only ONE passenger pigeon left: MARTHA.
Mid-century archival: family meal	KEVIN (VO): See, people didn't realize that this abundant food source wasn't gonna stay abundant forever, and once they did, all conservation efforts proved to be too little, too late.
Animated map: Cincinnati to the Smithsonian	KEVIN (VO): When Martha died at her home in the Cincinnati Zoo, her body was put on ice and shipped to the Smithsonian.
Archival: grief reaction	KEVIN (VO): Today you can find her there, a solemn reminder of a species we took for granted.
Archival: freight and shipping	GAG VO (sincere): "Bon voyage, little pigeon... we won't forget you..."
Archival with title treatment	KEVIN (VO): I know what you're thinking. Kevin, that was a long time ago. We wouldn't make that same kind of mistake again. We're smarter now!
Contemporary: industrial fishing	KEVIN (VO): Yeah, but... are we? Are we really?
Archival: investigation motif	KEVIN (VO): Don't worry. We haven't slid into Martha territory quite yet.

VIDEO	AUDIO
Archival: young man, reflective	KEVIN (VO): Just food for thought.
Vintage "THE END" card	KEVIN (VO): That's time.
Branded end card with CTA buttons	KEVIN (VO): Want more Martha? Click here to check artistic renditions brought to you by The Henry Ford and the Library of Virginia...
End card, colour variant	KEVIN (VO): ...proud partners of Google Arts & Culture.
End card holds	KEVIN (VO): And make sure to subscribe to the Google Arts & Culture channel for a ton of great content by clicking here. See ya!